

Connect 2.0 Journeys

Every path a student or a professional can take through the Connect tab, what happens at each step, where it breaks, and what is built on the connect-2-0 branch versus proposed.

Dreamari prototype · branch connect-2-0 · 3 September 2026 · source brief: DREAMARI
CONNECT 2.pdf

One rule ranks everything else: the least information that still does the job. An 8th grader should never have to work out what a screen is for.

Who lands on Connect

PERSON	ARRIVES WITH	WANTS	FEAR
New student, 13 to 15	Nothing yet, maybe a Match Top 3	To ask one real question and see who does the job	Looking dumb in public, strangers
Returning student	Top 3, a question they asked, people they follow	Did anyone answer me? What did my people post?	Missing the answer, having to dig
Event attendee	An event code from JA or Dream Opportunity	The room for the event they went to	Losing the code
Professional, Founding 150	A verified account, ten minutes a week	One question worth answering, proof it mattered	Obligation, being judged for volunteering rarely
Partner or employer, later	Sponsorship	Company-level proof of impact	Nothing to show

The one loop

Every screen exists to move one step of this loop. Nothing on the tab is there for its own sake.

1

Student asks

From the landing, a board or a profile.

2

Dreamari routes it

To the verified pros in the right community.

3

A pro answers in minutes

Answer or Skip, never an obligation.

4

Students read, like, save, follow

One answer helps every student who reads it.

5

The pro sees the impact, privately

Then the next relevant question arrives.

The landing, top to bottom

1

Find your community, Community / Events toggle, search

Unchanged from the approved design.

2

Your questions

The tab's one primary action, Ask a question, sits in this panel's header. Rows are the student's own questions with one or two words of status: New answer, Answered, Waiting for an answer. The last row opens Saved. A student who has never asked sees one sentence and the button. A returning student's whole reason for coming is answered in one glance.

3

Your Communities

The doors. The approved photo cards with stat tiles, Pros from logos and the ghost action.

4**People to Follow**

Below the communities. Instagram's suggestion shape: portrait, name, what they do, the company as its logo, Follow. Nothing else. Ranked relevance first from the Match Top 3, activity second.

5**New from people you follow**

Appears only after the first follow. Up to four rows: who, answered or posted, the title.

People come after places because a student's first question is "where do I ask about nursing", not "which nurse". The community answers that. The rail then makes the community human, and Following gives a reason to come back.

Journeys

1. First visit with a Top 3**BUILT**

Home → Connect. Your questions in its empty state with the Ask button, the communities matching the Top 3 already joined, People to Follow labelled "Picked for your Top 3". Taps Ask.

2. First visit without a Top 3**COPY DECISION**

Same screen. The rail falls back to quality and activity and drops its label. Proposed: one line under the rail, "Pick your Top 3 in Match and we will pick people for you", linking to Match.

3. Ask a question

BUILT

Three entry points, one behaviour: the landing's Ask button, the composer on a community board, the Ask Me Anything composer on a profile. The Ask sheet picks where the question goes from its words ("bank" sends it to Finance Careers) and one tap on a chip changes that. When a question with the same words was already answered, up to two "Already answered" rows appear above Post, so one tap reads the answer with no waiting. Phone numbers, emails, @handles and DM apps block Post with a plain sentence and keep the draft. After Post, a toast says where it went and the usual wait, and the question appears under Your questions as Waiting.

4. Waiting, then a new answer

BUILT

STILL WAITING STATE NEEDS BACKEND

Waiting: the row says so, the thread says where the question went and how long it usually takes. Answered: the row flips to New answer in green. The thread shows the primary answer marked, likes by the question, Like, Save and Report under each answer. Proposed for later: after the community's window passes, "Still waiting. We asked more pros." with a link to similar answered questions.

5. Follow a professional

BUILT

From the rail, a profile, or any name in a badge, an insight card or a comment. Follow flips to Following and the count ticks. New from people you follow appears on the landing. Students follow pros; there is no reverse.

6. Browse a community

BUILT EARLIER

Card → board with Feed (Student Questions, Professional Insights) and About (purpose, topics, Pros from logos, response window). Not joined → Join sheet: what you get, one ground rule, Agree and Join.

7. Save

BUILT

Save on any question, answer or post. The toast used to say "Find it under Saved" and Saved did not exist. It does now: Your questions → Saved answers and posts → one panel of rows (Question, Answer by, Post by, Event takeaways).

8. Event attendee

BUILT EARLIER

Events tab → event card → Enter Code → the board unlocks and stays under Your events.

9. Report

BUILT

Report on a thread or an answer opens a sheet with four reasons and Send report, then a toast: "Thanks. A moderator will look at it." The reporter is never revealed. Report was inert before.

10. Professional: routed question to answer

BUILT AS PREVIEW

"Three students asked questions about investment banking this week. Answer one?" Each routed question is a row with Answer and Skip. Answer opens a three-line composer; Post answer shows "Live on Finance Careers" with a link to the thread, and Questions Answered ticks up. Skip: "Skipped. Nothing changes." The headline counts down as questions are handled. Reached at /connect?dashboard=pro; no student entry point.

11. Professional: posts, impact, recognition

BUILT AS PREVIEW

Career posts from four prompts, optional. Private Impact Dashboard with the brief's six numbers, the positive activity sentence, "Active weekly. Only you can see this.", and the company line with the company's logo. 2026 Impact Summary with Download and who to share it with.

Edge cases and empty states

CASE

WHAT HAPPENS

Never asked anything

Your questions shows one sentence and the Ask button

Asked, nobody answered yet

Row says Waiting for an answer; the thread says where it went and the usual wait

Question already answered by someone else	Ask sheet shows it before Post; one tap reads it
Question contains contact details	Post is blocked with a plain reason; the draft is kept
Not joined, tries to ask on a board	Join sheet first
Follows nobody	No Following section; the rail is the invitation
Follows people with nothing new	Following section hides itself
No Top 3	Rail ranks by quality and activity; no "Picked for your Top 3" label
Nothing saved	Saved view says how to save
Company with no exact logo	Text chip at the same size (none today; Goldman Sachs and Blackstone marks added)
Wrong event code	Inline error in the code sheet
Upcoming event	Card says the board opens after the event

Pain points in the previous Connect

PAIN	STATUS
Asking was two levels deep	Fixed: Ask from the landing, routed by the words
No way to see your own questions or whether anyone answered	Fixed: Your questions panel
"Find it under Saved" but no Saved anywhere	Fixed: Saved view
Report buttons did nothing	Fixed: Report sheet with confirmation
People cards repeated the role, a field chip and a follower count	Fixed: portrait, name, role, logo, Follow
People rail sat above the communities	Fixed: below

Pill-shaped composer and chips	Fixed: 12px composer, 8px chips
Following did nothing after the count ticked	Fixed: New from people you follow
Pro "Answer" was a one-line message, not a flow	Fixed: routed rows with a real composer
Company names as text where a logo exists	Fixed: logos in chips, profiles, badges, insight cards, dashboard

Safety by design, visible

- Students follow pros; pros never follow students; students have no follower counts anywhere.
- No message entry point exists. Every composer says answers are public.
- Contact details are blocked at the composer.
- Report is one tap away on every thread and answer, with a confirmation.
- Pros see a grade, never a full name, and every composer footer says so.
- A verification line on every profile.

Copy rules for an 8th grader

One idea per line. Say what happens next: "Sent to verified pros in Finance Careers." Status is one or two words. No system words such as routed, moderation queue or entitlement. No em dashes.

Deferred, needs backend or a decision

Real routing and the time-based Still waiting state. Persisted follows, saves and questions. A notification badge on the Connect tab. Pro login and the real dashboard. Anonymized outcomes such as "18 students you supported graduated". Company-level aggregation. The invite flow for the Founding 150.

Alignment with the CEO's Replit

dceai.replit.app, read 3 September 2026. Design ignored on purpose; the flows and elements are what matter so ours line up with his mental model.

REPLIT ELEMENT	OURS
Connect header trust line, "Verified professionals · Moderated questions"	Safety line in every composer and on profiles. Worth one trust line under the Connect title
Communities / People as two tabs; People has filters and three rails (Recommended, Popular This Week, New Professionals)	One ranked rail under the communities, relevance first. Filters and extra rails skipped for load
Person card with initials, role, company, View profile, Follow, "18.4K students reached · 3.2K followers"	Portrait, name, role, company logo, Follow. Counts live on the profile
Enter Community only shows a toast; no board yet	Full boards: Student Questions, Professional Insights, About
Profile tabs Ask Me Anything / Posts / About; Report on each answer; View discussion	Same numbers and AMA. About (education, career journey, topics) not built; a good folded section to add
Volunteer dashboard, My Profile: "64 asked · 58 answered", questions with Awaiting / Answered, My Posts with Create Post, the pro's communities	Routed questions with Answer / Skip and an inline composer; post prompts. Asked/answered counter and the pro's communities not shown
Volunteer dashboard, My Impact: six numbers with percent change each, 30-day chart, "Your advice is moving people forward", Gold volunteer status with "no penalty for taking a break"	Six numbers, one overall change, the positive sentence, "Active weekly. Only you can see this." Per-number deltas and chart skipped; tier stays private per the brief
Corporate Partnership Dashboard: Export; Overview, Financial Oversight, DO Events, DCAI Mentorship, Impact Quality; goals vs targets; in-person vs virtual; events with fill; budget; regional growth; satisfaction	Partner view: Export, 2026 goals with progress, In person vs On Dreamari lanes, events, professionals, satisfaction line. Budget and regions left out
Student My Profile: Top 3, Plan, Career Report, "Do this next", Coming up	Matches our Profile; "Do this next" is the Home proposal's next-step line

Not in the Replit yet: Saved, Report with reasons, the Ask sheet with routing and already-answered matches, New from people you follow, event code boards. Those come from the brief and the earlier handoff.

Demo switch

A segmented control tops every Connect screen: Student · Event attendee · Volunteer · Partner. It rides the URL as ?as=, so each journey has a link.

Home page: evaluation and proposal

What Home does today

- A three-panel hero carousel: Today's Drop, Continue the simulation, a trending career.
- A Continue rail of three activity cards.
- A rail of recommended careers, identical to Explore's.
- The Your Signal banner to the Career Report.

Where it underserves

- Two of three hero panels repeat what sits directly below. Carousels are the least-read element on any home page.
- Nothing from Connect reaches Home. A student with an answer waiting has no idea.
- Nothing about the student's spine, Build → Match → Top 3 → Play. Before and after Match look the same.
- "View all activity" goes nowhere.

Proposal, same length, less to read

1 Hero, one panel, state-aware

Today's Drop stays as the hero, it is the daily habit. Under it, one line for the next step in the spine: "Finish Match to get your Top 3" or "Continue: The \$30B Deal, 18 min left". No carousel.

2 Continue rail

Keep as is.

3

From Connect

One panel, up to three rows: new answers to your questions, new from people you follow. Empty state: "Ask a pro anything" with the Ask button. This is where the Connect loop earns a return visit.

4

Your Top 3

Three poster cards with a one-line progress each (played, glossary, asked). Replaces the recommended rail; Explore keeps the recommendations.

5

Your Signal banner

Keep.

Not built. It changes an approved Home, so it waits for a go-ahead.

Part two: audit

UX audit, competitive audit and heuristic evaluation of every Connect screen, and what the rebuild changed.

Branch `connect-2-0`, 2026-09-03. Inputs: DREAMARI CONNECT 2.pdf, the CEO's Replit (dceai.replit.app: /community-boards, profile, /volunteer/dashboard with My Profile and My Impact tabs, /corporate/dashboard), our branch as of commit 7c5287c. Method: Nielsen's ten heuristics per screen, severity 1 (cosmetic) to 4 (blocks the task); a pattern audit of products our users and volunteers already know; then a build list, all of which is implemented on the branch.

1. What was wrong with the branch before this pass

SCREEN	FINDING	HEURISTIC	SEVERITY
Volunteer dashboard	No My Profile / My Impact split. The Replit and the brief both treat "what students asked me" and "what my help did" as two jobs; ours mixed them in one scroll.	Match between system and real world; recognition over recall	3

Volunteer dashboard	Impact was six numbers with one overall +28%. No per-metric change, no trend, no time range. A volunteer cannot see whether they are growing.	Visibility of system status	3
Volunteer dashboard	Activity status (Gold, weekly) buried as a sentence. The brief wants it private but motivating; the Replit gives it a card with "no penalty for taking a break".	Visibility of system status; help and documentation	2
Volunteer dashboard	"Career posts" was four prompt chips with no post list, no create flow, no signals per post. The Replit has My Posts with views, likes, saves and Create Post.	User control and freedom	3
Volunteer dashboard	No "asked · answered" counter; no way to see communities the volunteer belongs to.	Visibility of system status	2
Volunteer dashboard	Skip had no undo.	User control and freedom; error recovery	2
Volunteer dashboard	Impact Summary was numbers in a panel. The brief says "like Spotify Wrapped": something a person would actually post.	Aesthetic and minimalist design (in the sense of designed, not bare)	3
Everywhere	Every section was the same frosted panel with text rows. No charts, rings, portraits or marks doing the work words were doing. Reads as "words and boxes".	Aesthetic and minimalist design; recognition over recall	3
Profile	No About (education, career journey, topics they can help with). The Replit has it; students asking "how did you get here" have nowhere to look.	Recognition over recall	2
Connect landing	No trust line. The Replit opens with "Verified professionals · Moderated questions"; ours says it only inside composers. Parents and teachers read the top of the page.	Help and documentation; visibility of status	2
Your questions	Rows said "New answer" without saying who answered. A face and a name is the whole point.	Recognition over recall	2

Partner view	Progress bars and text only; the Replit's dashboard is rings, split bars and fill meters that read at a glance.	Visibility of status	2
Community board	Two levels of tabs: Feed / About pills inside the photo banner, then a second Student Questions / Professional Insights filter row inside a tinted wrapper card. Cards inside a card.	Consistency; aesthetic and minimalist	3
Community board	About was a bespoke tinted card with its own kicker labels, unlike every other section.	Consistency and standards	2
Thread and insight thread	The Back control was a cream-tinted pill from an older exploration: light ink on a light fill inside a dark UI. Off-system.	Consistency and standards	2
Thread	Like appeared twice: beside the question (correct, per CEO note) and again in the bottom row.	Consistency; minimalist	2
Thread	No way to follow the professional from their answer. The Replit puts "Follow Sarah" under the answer; the brief's loop depends on it (read → follow).	Recognition; flexibility	3
Insight thread	Report was inert.	Error recovery	2
Everywhere a company is named	Bare white logo marks sat off the text line (the JPMorgan wordmark floated above its row).	Consistency; aesthetic	2
Community cards	Approved. Photo, four stat tiles, Pros from chips, ghost action. Not changed.		
Events tab	Cards and code flow work; the partner mark sits on the card. Not changed this pass; the one issue is the upcoming-event card with no action, acceptable.		1
Join sheet	Three perks, one rule, Agree and Join. Clear. Not changed.		

Kept, because the audit confirmed them: Ask from the landing with routing and already-answered matches; contact-info block; Report with reasons; Saved; People to Follow below the communities as portrait cards; hairline rows inside one panel per section; strict type hierarchy; plain status words.

2. Competitive audit: patterns our users already know

PRODUCT	PATTERN	WHAT WE TAKE	WHAT WE LEAVE
TikTok / Instagram creator analytics	Metric tiles with a percent change each; one chart with a 7 / 30 / 90 day switch; "Post" as the primary action	Metric tiles with deltas, the 30-day area chart with a range switch	Follower demographics, watch time
Spotify Wrapped / Strava Year in Sport	One shareable card: gradient, four big numbers, your name, the year	The 2026 Impact Summary as a card you can download and post	Slideshow, sound
Stack Overflow / Quora	"Questions for you" inbox: routed questions with counts, Answer / Skip, unanswered badge	Routed rows with asked · answered counter, Skip with Undo	Reputation points, downvotes
LinkedIn profile	Headline, About, Experience, "Talks about" topics; posts with reactions	About section with education, career journey, topics they can help with	Connections, endorsements, messaging
Duolingo	Positive streak copy; never shame; private progress	"Gold volunteer. You helped this week. No penalty for taking a break." Only you can see this	Public leagues
Handshake / Forage	Employer logos as trust; verified badges; student privacy first	Company marks everywhere a company is named; verified shield; grade-only identity	Job applications
Reddit AMA	One person, public questions, upvoted answers	Ask Me Anything as the primary engagement; public answers	Threads of threads, karma

Corporate CSR dashboards (Benevity, Goodera)	Goals vs targets as rings, volunteer hours, events with fill rates, exportable report	Goal rings, in-person vs virtual split bar, events with fill meters, Export	Budget approvals, payroll giving
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3. Heuristic evaluation, after the rebuild

HEURISTIC	HOW CONNECT MEETS IT NOW
Visibility of system status	Your questions with who answered; asked · answered counter; per-metric deltas; chart; goal rings; "Live on Finance Careers" after posting
Match to the real world	Plain words: New answer, Waiting, Answered, Skipped. Roles named as people say them: Student, Volunteer, Partner
User control and freedom	Cancel on every composer; Undo on Skip; Back on every screen; role switch always visible in the demo
Consistency and standards	One Panel shell, one row style, one metric tile, one Follow button, one segmented control for every tab set
Error prevention	Contact details blocked before Post; Post disabled until there is text; similar answered questions shown before posting
Recognition over recall	Portraits, company marks, community photos, status colours with words, icons on every metric
Flexibility and efficiency	Every screen has a URL; Ask from three places; keyboard: Enter posts, Shift+Enter breaks
Aesthetic and minimalist design	One chart, one card, rings where numbers are goals; nothing decorative that does not carry data
Help users recover from errors	Report confirms; wrong event code explains; blocked post keeps the draft and says why
Help and documentation	Trust line under the Connect title; one safety line per composer; "Only you can see this" on private analytics

4. Build list from this audit (implemented on the branch)

- 1 Volunteer dashboard split into ****My Profile**** and ****My Impact**** with a segmented control.
 - 2 My Profile: Ask Me Anything with asked · answered, routed rows with student identity and status, Answer with inline composer, Skip with Undo; My posts with signals and Create post from prompts; My communities.
 - 3 My Impact: headline sentence; six metric tiles with icon and delta; 30-day students-reached area chart with range switch; Gold volunteer status card; company on Dreamari; 2026 Impact Summary as a shareable card with Download and share targets.
 - 4 Profile: About panel (education, career journey, topics they can help with) for every professional.
 - 5 Connect landing: trust line under the title; Your questions rows show who answered with their portrait.
 - 6 Partner view: goal rings, in-person vs on-Dreamari split bar, events with fill meters.
 - 7 Shared visual primitives in `viz.tsx`: MetricTile, AreaChart, Ring, Meter, Segmented.
 - 8 Community board: one segmented row (Questions · Insights · About) under the banner, counts in the tabs, feed cards straight on the page, About as the standard panel.
 - 9 Threads: standard Back link; one Like, beside the question; Follow on every answer card; Report wired on insights.
 - 10 Company logos in the chip everywhere (three chip sizes), never a bare mark beside text.
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5. Not built, and why

Real analytics, time ranges and deltas need a backend. Per-region growth and budget belong to the corporate product, not the prototype. Public activity tiers are excluded by the brief. Private messaging is excluded by design.